Orbit Digital

Technical and Commercial Proposal

Response to RFP MRWB-2026-014: Customer Service and Billing Platform Modernisation

Issued by: Meridian Regional Water Board (fictional)

Submitted: 2026-10-22

Item	Detail
Bidder	Orbit Digital Services Ltd., Bengaluru, India
Proposed solution	Orbit UtilityOne billing and customer engagement suite
Duration	Approximately 36 weeks
Estimated 3-year cost	INR 10.85 Cr (time and materials estimate)
Experience	22 billing implementations, 14 utility clients

This is a fictional proposal created for a classroom exercise. All organisations, people and figures are invented.

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

2. Proposed Solution and Architecture

3. Integration Approach

4. Implementation Approach

5. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

6. Commercial Proposal and Price Table

7. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

8. Support Model and Service Level Agreement

9. Relevant Experience and References

10. Assumptions and Exclusions

11. Appendices

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Orbit Digital has served the utilities sector for 18 years and has delivered more billing transformations than any other firm in the region. We bring an experienced team, strong client relationships and a portfolio of 14 utility clients who can speak to our results.

The Board wishes to modernise billing and customer service, improve customer satisfaction and reduce operational cost. We have seen these challenges many times before.

Our long track record means we understand how utility organisations work, how regulators think and how to keep customers informed during change. We have worked with water, electricity and gas utilities of all sizes, and we know that every transformation has its own character.

- 18 years in the utilities sector.
- 22 completed billing implementations, including water utilities of a similar scale.
- 5 reference clients who have agreed to be contacted.
- A mature product, UtilityOne, which has been refined across many deployments.
- A Bengaluru-based service centre providing 24x7 coverage for critical incidents.

Our experience in numbers

Measure	Value
Years in utilities	18
Billing implementations completed	22
Utility clients served	14
Largest deployment	1.1 million connections (Northbank Water Utility)
Staff in utilities practice	120

Company history

Orbit Digital was established in 2008 in Bengaluru by a group of former enterprise software professionals who saw an opportunity to bring modern technology to the utilities sector. In our first five years we focused on billing and customer information systems for electricity distribution companies. From 2013 we broadened our offering to water and gas utilities, and in 2017 we launched the first version of UtilityOne. In 2021 we opened our

second delivery centre, and in 2024 we crossed the milestone of 120 employees in our utilities practice. Throughout this journey we have remained committed to a simple idea: that utilities deserve technology partners who truly understand their world.

Year	Milestone
2008	Orbit Digital founded in Bengaluru
2011	First electricity billing engagement completed
2013	Entry into the water and gas sectors
2017	UtilityOne first released
2019	Bengaluru service centre extended to 24x7 coverage for critical incidents
2021	Second delivery centre opened
2024	Utilities practice reaches 120 staff
2025	Northbank Water Utility go-live on UtilityOne

Our values

We hold five values close. Partnership means working shoulder to shoulder with clients. Integrity means doing what we say. Excellence means striving for quality in everything we do. Innovation means looking for better ways. Sustainability means caring about the long-term impact of our work on communities and the environment. These values guide our daily decisions and are reflected in the way we build and support our solutions.

Why Orbit Digital

Choosing a billing partner is a decision that will shape a utility for a decade. We believe the most reliable predictor of success is experience, and few firms can match ours. Our consultants have seen the pitfalls and know how to avoid them. Our clients tell us that our people are our greatest strength: knowledgeable, calm under pressure and genuinely invested in their success.

Our people

Orbit's strength lies in its people. Our utilities practice brings together business analysts, solution architects, technical consultants, testers and trainers, many of whom have been with Orbit for more than a decade. We invest in learning, with every consultant receiving at least 40 hours of training per year, and we encourage our staff to gain professional certifications. We believe that a stable, experienced team provides continuity and reassurance to clients, and it is our practice to keep key personnel on an engagement from start to finish wherever possible.

Our commitment to the Board

We are honoured to be invited to respond to this RFP. We understand the importance of the Board's mission and the trust that customers place in it. If selected, Orbit will bring the full weight of its experience, energy and commitment to the programme.

2. Proposed Solution and Architecture

We will deploy Orbit UtilityOne, our billing and customer engagement suite, hosted in a cloud region in India. UtilityOne includes billing, payments, a customer portal and a contact-centre module.

UtilityOne is a mature product that has evolved over more than a decade. It is multi-tenant in design but will be deployed as a dedicated instance for the Board. The suite is organised into modules which can be switched on as the Board is ready.

Module	Description
Billing	Metering-to-cash processing with configurable tariffs
Payments	Online, counter and agent payments with reconciliation
Customer portal	Self-service for bills, payments and requests

Module	Description
Contact centre	Case management and call handling
Reporting	Standard operational and management reports

Hosting will be in a cloud region in India with backups. Detailed sizing, resilience design and performance targets will be agreed during design. Scalability will be assessed during design.

Product overview

UtilityOne is more than a billing system. It is an integrated suite that supports the entire customer relationship, from connection request to final bill. The suite has been continuously enhanced based on feedback from our user community. Its modular design allows utilities to adopt functionality at their own pace, while a common customer record ensures a consistent experience across channels.

Module	Highlights
Billing and rating	Flexible tariffs, multiple bill cycles, estimated billing, adjustments and rebates
Collections	Payment plans, reminders, disconnection workflow
Customer portal	Account view, online payment, service requests, notifications
Contact centre	Case management, scripts, knowledge base
Field service	Work order management and scheduling
Reporting and dashboards	Standard reports and a configurable dashboard

Roadmap and innovation

Orbit continues to invest in UtilityOne. Our product roadmap includes enhanced analytics, a refreshed user interface, expanded mobile capabilities and further use of automation. Roadmap items are subject to change and will be shared with customers through our user forum. We also take part in industry events and working groups to keep pace with the changing needs of utilities.

Hosting and operations

UtilityOne will be hosted in a cloud region in India. Orbit will manage the environment, apply updates and monitor performance. Exact environment sizes, redundancy arrangements and recovery objectives will be proposed in design and agreed with the Board.

Customer experience vision

Today's customers expect convenience. UtilityOne's portal is designed to give customers a single place to see their bills, make payments, request services and receive notifications. We aim to make every interaction simple, whether the customer is online, on a phone or at a counter. The user interface will be configured with the Board's branding, and language options will be agreed during design.

Reporting

UtilityOne includes standard reports for billing, collections and customer service. The Board will also be able to define custom reports. A full list of reports and the data warehouse approach will be agreed during design.

3. Integration Approach

Integration approach: integrations with SAP and the meter data management system will be determined during the discovery phase once we understand the Board's landscape. Our team has integrated with many systems in the past and we are confident this will not be an issue. Scalability will be assessed during design.

System	Approach	Status
SAP S/4HANA	Method to be confirmed in discovery	To be confirmed
Meter data management	Interfaces to be defined with the Board's team	To be confirmed
Payment gateways	Standard gateway adapters, selection with the Board	To be confirmed
Other systems	Identified during discovery	To be confirmed

Specific protocols, data volumes and test approaches will be to be confirmed in discovery. Because the integration scope is not yet known, effort and cost for integrations are included only as an allowance and may change.

Integration principles

We have extensive experience of connecting UtilityOne with the systems that utilities depend on. Our general principles are to reuse standard connectors where possible, to prefer loosely coupled integration and to test interfaces thoroughly. We believe that early engagement with the owners of each system is the key to success, which is why we place such emphasis on discovery. By talking to the right people at the right time we will reduce risk and make good choices.

Topic	Position
Interface technology	To be confirmed in discovery
Data volumes and frequencies	To be confirmed in discovery
Error handling and reconciliation	To be confirmed in discovery
Environments and test data	To be confirmed in discovery
Effort and price for integration	Allowance only; to be confirmed after discovery
Responsibility split with Board IT and SAP team	To be confirmed in discovery

We will provide an integration approach document at the end of discovery. Until then we cannot commit to specific interface designs, performance figures or dates for integration milestones.

4. Implementation Approach

Our methodology has been refined over 18 years. The programme will take approximately 36 weeks.

The methodology is organised into four phases, each led by an experienced consultant. Discovery establishes the detail of what is needed; configuration and integration builds it; testing checks it; deployment brings it into live use. Our consultants will work closely with the Board's team throughout and adapt the approach to the Board's culture.

- Discovery workshops with each business area.
- Iterative configuration with regular reviews.
- Testing with the Board's users before go-live.
- Deployment support and a handover to our service centre.

Data migration and training

Data migration approach will be defined in discovery. Training will be delivered to the Board's staff before go-live; the number and format of sessions will be agreed in discovery.

Methodology overview

Orbit's delivery methodology, OrbitWay, brings together good practices from many years of experience. It provides a common language for our teams and clients, a consistent set of deliverables and a flexible framework that can be adapted to each engagement. OrbitWay is not a rigid process; it is a toolkit that our consultants apply with judgement.

Phase	Purpose	Typical activities
Discovery	Understand the organisation and agree the way forward	Workshops, interviews, review of existing systems, definition of scope
Configuration and integration	Build the solution	Configure UtilityOne, develop interfaces, prepare data
Testing	Check that it works	Test planning, test execution, defect resolution, user acceptance
Deployment	Bring the solution into use	Training, cutover, go-live support

Governance and communication

Each engagement has a governance structure appropriate to its size. Typically this includes a steering committee that meets periodically, a project board and regular status reports. The engagement partner remains accessible to the Board throughout. Communication is encouraged at all levels, and we find that open, honest dialogue is the foundation of successful projects.

Quality and risk management

Quality is everyone's responsibility at Orbit. Our consultants follow internal quality guidelines and deliverables are reviewed by experienced colleagues. Risks are identified, assessed and monitored throughout the project. We believe that proactive risk management is the mark of a mature organisation.

Change management and training

Successful adoption depends on people. Orbit's approach to change management emphasises stakeholder engagement, clear communication and practical training. A training approach will be developed during discovery taking into account the number of users, their roles and the Board's preferences.

Data migration

Data migration is a critical activity. Our consultants have migrated data from many legacy systems. The approach, tools, number of trial loads and reconciliation method will be defined during discovery once the Board's data has been reviewed.

Sample deliverables

Phase	Typical deliverables
Discovery	Discovery report, scope statement, high-level design, project plan
Configuration and integration	Configured system, interface descriptions, migration scripts
Testing	Test plan, test results, defect log, acceptance certificate
Deployment	Training materials, cutover plan, go-live report, handover

The content, number and timing of these deliverables will be tailored to the Board during discovery.

5. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

Phase	Approximate duration
Discovery	8 weeks
Configuration and integration	16 weeks
Testing	8 weeks
Deployment	4 weeks

Team: an engagement partner, a project manager and a team of consultants whose size will be confirmed after discovery. Detailed milestones will be agreed after discovery.

Role	Number
Engagement partner	1
Project manager	1
Consultants	To be confirmed after discovery

The phase durations above are approximate and will be refined at the end of discovery. Factors that may affect duration include the scope of integrations, data quality, availability of Board staff and the number of business processes to be configured. Orbit will provide a baseline plan at the end of discovery.

Item	Position
Detailed project plan	After discovery

Item	Position
Named milestones and acceptance criteria	After discovery
Team size by phase	After discovery
Go-live date	Approximately week 36; to be confirmed after discovery

6. Commercial Proposal and Price Table

Item	Price (INR)
Implementation services (time and materials estimate)	5,20,00,000
UtilityOne licence and hosting, 3 years	5,40,00,000
Training	25,00,000
Estimated total 3-year cost	10,85,00,000

Implementation is estimated on a time-and-materials basis at a blended rate of INR 16,000 per person-day; the final figure depends on integration scope confirmed in discovery. Licence prices increase in line with inflation each year.

The estimate assumes about 3,250 person-days. Invoices for implementation will be raised monthly on actual time spent. Orbit will notify the Board if the estimate is likely to be exceeded. Any additional work beyond the estimate will be charged at the same rate.

Note that the total above is an estimate and not a fixed or capped price.

Commercial approach

Orbit prefers a time-and-materials approach for implementation because it provides flexibility and allows the Board to respond to what is learned during discovery. Many of our clients have found that this approach leads to better outcomes than fixed prices, which can discourage change. We will share timesheets and monthly burn-down information so that the Board can monitor effort.

Element	Basis
Implementation services	Time and materials at a blended INR 16,000 per person-day; estimate only
Licence and hosting	Three-year fee; annual increase in line with inflation
Training	Estimated; depends on number of sessions agreed in discovery
Integration allowance	Included in the estimate; may change after discovery
Expenses	Travel and accommodation charged at actuals
Taxes	GST extra

Invoices are issued monthly in arrears for time worked and annually in advance for licences. Payment is due within 30 days.

7. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Orbit Digital is ISO 27001 certified. UtilityOne supports role-based access control, encryption of data in transit and at rest, and audit logging. We comply with Indian data protection regulations. Penetration testing is performed annually.

Risk	Mitigation
Integration scope larger than expected	Review in discovery; adjust estimate
Schedule slippage	Regular status reviews
Data protection	Comply with applicable regulations

Information security approach

Orbit takes information security seriously and has an information security management system aligned to ISO 27001. Our staff receive security awareness training, and our service centre follows documented procedures. We work with clients to understand their security requirements and to implement appropriate measures. Specific controls for the Board's environment will be agreed in design.

Area	Orbit position
Certification	ISO 27001 certified
Access control	Role-based access
Encryption	In transit and at rest
Audit logging	Supported by UtilityOne
Penetration testing	Annual
Data protection	Compliance with Indian data protection regulations
Incident response	Per support agreement
Disaster recovery objectives	To be agreed in design

More detailed security documentation can be provided after contract award.

8. Support Model and Service Level Agreement

Support is provided through our Bengaluru service centre with 24x7 coverage for critical incidents, a named account manager and an escalation path to the engagement partner. Priority 1 response within 1 hour.

Priority	Response
P1 Critical	Within 1 hour, 24x7
P2 High	Within 4 business hours
P3 and P4	Within 2 business days

Resolution targets and availability commitments will be set out in the support agreement.

Service approach

Orbit's service centre in Bengaluru supports clients across several sectors. Support staff are trained on UtilityOne and have access to engineers when needed. We believe in building long-term relationships and regularly meet our clients to review service. The support agreement, including service hours, resolution targets, service credits and reporting, will be finalised with the Board after contract award.

Item	Position
Critical incidents	24x7 coverage; response within 1 hour
Other incidents	Business hours; response times in support agreement
Account management	Named account manager
Reviews	Periodic service reviews
Availability target	To be agreed

9. Relevant Experience and References

Experience: 18 years in utilities, 14 utility clients and 22 completed billing implementations, including water, electricity and gas utilities.

Reference client (fictional)	Scope	Year
Northbank Water Utility	UtilityOne billing, 1.1 million connections	2025
Riverside Electricity Board	Billing and contact centre	2024
Greenfield Gas Company	Billing replacement	2023

Reference client (fictional)	Scope	Year
Central Plains Water Trust	Billing and customer portal	2022
Metro Water and Sewerage Board	Billing upgrade	2021

All references have agreed to be contacted by the Board.

Selected project highlights

- Northbank Water Utility: replaced a 20-year-old billing system for 1.1 million connections and migrated customer records to UtilityOne.
- Riverside Electricity Board: implemented billing and a contact-centre module for a regional electricity board.
- Greenfield Gas Company: replaced billing within the planned period.
- Central Plains Water Trust and Metro Water and Sewerage Board: billing and portal upgrades completed for water utilities.

Client testimonials (summary)

Our clients regularly tell us that Orbit is a dependable partner. Northbank Water Utility described the programme as a landmark for the organisation. Riverside Electricity Board commended the professionalism of the project team. Greenfield Gas Company noted the smooth transition to the new system. Central Plains Water Trust and Metro Water and Sewerage Board have both continued to work with Orbit for further enhancements.

Experience dimension	Orbit position
Utility billing implementations	22 completed
Utility clients	14
References offered	5, all agreed to be contacted
Sectors	Water, electricity and gas
Largest deployment	1.1 million connections

10. Assumptions and Exclusions

- Integration scope and effort will be confirmed in discovery and may change the estimate.
- The Board provides timely access to its SAP and MDM teams and systems.
- Team size and milestones will be agreed after discovery.
- Prices exclude GST, hosting growth beyond the standard configuration and third-party charges.
- Licence prices increase annually in line with inflation.

Additional terms (summary)

- Orbit will provide services in accordance with a master services agreement to be negotiated with the Board.
- Intellectual property in UtilityOne remains with Orbit; the Board receives a licence for the term.
- Liability is limited to the fees paid under the relevant statement of work.
- Either party may terminate for material breach after a 30-day cure period.
- Orbit may use subcontractors with the Board's consent.
- Confidential information will be protected.
- The proposal is valid for 90 days from submission.

Other assumptions: the Board will make decisions promptly, will nominate counterparts for each workstream and will provide access to documentation about existing systems. Orbit has assumed that the scope is broadly similar to that of its previous water utility engagements; differences will be identified in discovery. Orbit will also rely on the Board to supply representative test data and to arrange user availability for workshops and

acceptance testing.

11. Appendices

Appendix A: Key staff

Name (fictional)	Role	Experience
Suresh Menon	Engagement partner	24 years in utilities consulting; led Northbank programme
Divya Narayan	Project manager	14 years of billing project management

Appendix B: Glossary

Term	Meaning
T&M;	Time and materials, charging for actual effort
MDM	Meter data management system
Discovery	Initial phase to establish detailed requirements

Appendix C: Consultant profiles

Name (fictional)	Role	Profile
Suresh Menon	Engagement partner	24 years in utilities consulting; led Northbank programme; regular speaker at industry conferences
Divya Narayan	Project manager	14 years of billing project management; PMP; mentors junior managers
Rahul Khanna	Senior consultant	11 years in billing configuration; trained over 400 end users across clients
Ishita Bose	Senior consultant	9 years in customer portals and contact-centre modules
Manoj Pillai	Technical consultant	10 years in integration and data conversion for utilities

Appendix D: Frequently asked questions

Question	Answer
Will you integrate with SAP S/4HANA?	Yes, subject to confirmation of the approach in discovery.
Is the price fixed?	The implementation price is an estimate on a time-and-materials basis.
How many consultants will you assign?	The team size will be confirmed after discovery.
Can we speak to references?	Yes. All five references have agreed to be contacted.
Where is data hosted?	In a cloud region in India.
What happens at the end of the contract?	Data return and transition arrangements will be agreed in the contract.

Appendix E: Corporate social responsibility

Orbit Digital is committed to being a responsible corporate citizen. We support education programmes for underprivileged students, encourage employee volunteering and work to reduce the environmental impact of our operations. Our offices use renewable energy where available and we encourage remote working to reduce travel. We believe that business should contribute to the communities it serves.

Appendix F: Glossary

Term	Meaning
Discovery	Initial phase in which detailed requirements and scope are established
OrbitWay	Orbit's delivery methodology
T&M;	Time and materials
Blended rate	Average daily rate across roles
MDM	Meter data management system

Term	Meaning
Statement of work	Document describing the services for a particular engagement

Appendix G: Our approach to client relationships

Orbit believes in long-term partnerships. We hold regular executive meetings with key clients, invite clients to our annual user conference and set up user groups where customers can share experiences. Many of our clients have worked with us for more than ten years. We see every project as the beginning of a relationship rather than the end of a transaction. Our account managers are encouraged to understand each client's strategy so that we can recommend improvements that matter.

Appendix H: Awards and recognition

Orbit has been recognised by industry bodies for service quality and customer satisfaction. Our team has presented at regional utility conferences, and our clients have featured in trade publications. We are proud of this recognition, which reflects the dedication of our staff.

Appendix I: Next steps

Orbit would welcome the opportunity to present UtilityOne to the Board's evaluation committee and to discuss the discovery phase in more detail. We propose that, if selected, the first step would be a short mobilisation meeting to agree the discovery plan, followed by workshops with the Board's business and technology teams. At the end of discovery, Orbit will present a detailed plan, a refined estimate and a proposed team. The Board would then be able to confirm the next phases with a better understanding of the scope.

Step	Description
Presentation	UtilityOne demonstration and discussion at the Board's convenience
Mobilisation	Agree discovery plan and appoint counterparts
Discovery	Eight weeks of workshops and analysis
Refined estimate	Updated plan, team and price after discovery
Configuration onwards	Subject to Board approval of the refined plan

We thank the Board for the opportunity to respond and look forward to a long and productive partnership.

Appendix J: Document information

Item	Detail
Prepared by	Orbit Digital utilities bid team
Version	1.0
Validity	90 days from submission
Pricing status	Estimate; subject to confirmation after discovery
Contact	Engagement partner via the Orbit Digital Bengaluru office

Orbit regards this proposal as the starting point for a conversation. We expect that the details of scope, approach, team and price will be refined in discovery, and we look forward to working with the Board to do so.

End of proposal. This is a fictional proposal created for a classroom exercise; all organisations, people and figures are invented.